

5 FBML tags

FBML provides a large set of Facebook user interface and programmatic primitives required to abstract complex code and make most routine procedures effortless. The tags are automatically parsed and translated into HTML, CSS (Cascading Style Sheets), and JavaScript code by Facebook servers when a request for an application page that contains it is detected. If you've previously used HTML, then you will have no problems adapting to FBML. To distinguish between HTML and FBML commands in your application code, you need to prefix FBML tags with `fb:` as you would if you were using multiple DTDs/schemas in XHTML. FBML tags act differently in different locations. For example, you can use iframes on canvas pages, but you cannot use the same iframe on the code in the profile box due to platform limitations. Let us delve deeper into some well-known FBML tags.

5.1 Conditionals

FBML contains many conditional tests besides the `<fb:if>` tag that lets developers cut down on implementing conditional statements in their application. The basic `<fb:if>` tag is used like :

```
<fb:if value="true">
<p>Welcome.</p>
</fb:if>
```

The value can be set dynamically using the programming language you're making the application in. Suppose you want to test a user's ID and show a customised welcome message, you can write code like:

```
<?php
$user = $facebook->require_login();
$test = false;
if($user == 9999999){
    $test = 1;
}
?>
<fb:if value="<?php echo($test)?>">
<p>This is a customized welcome message. Welcome John</p>
</fb:if>
<fb:else>
<p>Welcome.</p>
```